commentary places India as part of the poor 'Third World' which cannot compare with China. India is full of slums and beggars, the distance with China is growing, and its economy will be left behind even by laggards such as Vietnam. Shen notes that Indian achievements in IT receive no credit. The overwhelming view is that 'India is crawling behind China, eating the Chinese dust'. Why so? The answer is its chaotic democracy and its religious and social attitudes.

India is also inferior militarily and strategically – yet capable of making trouble for China. Shen shows that Chinese netizens have little regard for India's military. India lost the 1962 war and its military performance since then has not impressed Chinese online opinion. India, in this view, would lose devastatingly to China if it chose to fight, its military being no better than China's in the Second World War.[75] Strategically, India is seen as being in league with Japan and the Western countries. Among the more nationalist-minded Chinese netizens, India is seen as a 'servile' follower, with little independence. At the same time, it is a troublemaker: it refuses to negotiate on the border and supports Tibetan separatism. Not surprisingly, a good proportion of the online posts think that a punitive war against India is inevitable.[76]

Jingoism . . . and Bollywood

A decade after his seminal study of online Chinese opinion, Shen teamed up with the Indian journalist Debasish Roy Chowdhary to untangle more recent attitudes towards India but also Indian views of China. Their study focused on mainstream and social media commentary on military issues, the Indian media's coverage of economic relations, and Chinese social media views of Bollywood films. At a broad level, they found that the Indian media's coverage of military affairs is 'marked by shrill jingoism and distrust reflecting the paranoia at the heart of India's elite perceptions'. The Chinese media is more sober, because it is under the watchful eye of the government, but it has increased its coverage of India and feeds off what it